

Converting a Foreign Licence to GACA

From an ICAO-state licence to a Saudi licence



Indicative study aid — not an official GACA document. Every age, hour, validity period and requirement must be verified against the current GACAR and confirmed with GACA before you rely on it. These points are condensed from the Fly GACA guide named below.

TWO ROUTES

- Validation — recognises an ICAO-state licence for one operator and time window. Fast (2–6 weeks), ~12-month limit.
- Conversion — a fresh GACA-stamped licence with full privileges. Slower (2–4 months).
- Long-term in the Kingdom: convert. Short contract: validate.

THE VERIFICATION PACKET

- A 9-document packet — licence, medical, logbook, ID / visa, training and rating records.
- Assemble every document in order before you apply.

THE BIGGEST BOTTLENECK

- The ICAO Doc 9379 regulator-to-regulator verification with the issuing authority.
- This authority-to-authority step drives the timeline.

EXAMS & CHECKS

- A Saudi air-law differential exam on the GACAR.
- Demonstrate ICAO English Level 4 or higher.
- A current GACA-accepted medical, and a GACA-administered skills test.

COST & REALITY

- Official fees are paid directly to GACA and the testing bodies.
- A preparation pack covers study and guidance only — not the licence itself.

Condensed from the full Fly GACA guide — <https://flygaca-firebase.web.app/guides/foreign-license-conversion-to-gaca.html>. Fly GACA is an independent educational reference and is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or connected to the General Authority of Civil Aviation (GACA). The authoritative source for any regulation is always GACA — gaca.gov.sa.